

that, I'm also grateful to have learned the immensely valuable lesson about working hard for every penny and making sure that the work I did was valued properly. These experiences gave me a very clear sense of the kind of work I found fulfilling—and the kind I didn't. They motivated me to do something with my life where I would be safe and financially rewarded.

Money Mistake: *You're Still Funding Your Teenager's Lifestyle*

The Fix: *No Free Tickets!*

One surefire way to nudge your teenagers into the workforce is by setting firm boundaries on what you will and will not pay for. Agree to pay for room, board and education—and then draw a line in the sand.

Last year, before Trevor's DJ business took off, I took him with me on a flight to Europe. As usual, I bought myself a first-class ticket. At this point in my life, I think I've earned the right to a more comfortable travel experience. But Trevor got a seat in economy. He wasn't happy about it. "Why do I have to sit all cramped up in the back?" he whined. "You always get the bigger screen and the better food!"

"Son, you can sit in the front any time you like—provided you pay for it."

"But I don't have that kind of cash!"

"Trevor," I said, "that's your problem, not mine."

When Linda travels with me, she likes the whole family to sit together, even though we could save 10 grand by putting Trevor and Savannah in the back. Because she's much more of a softie than I am, she'll say, "I can't do that." And I say, "Well, *I* can." And I have. I've bought my kids economy-class seats dozens of times.

Call me a monster if you want, but let's face it: it's not like I don't know where the kids are. I save a ton of money every time I do this, but that's not the real reason I make this choice. At 16, my son is making the connection between money and personal freedom. I think that's the greatest gift I've ever given him: to help him see that